There's An Amount Of Money That Would've Saved My Dad

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 19, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/nBt9aGUcQiA Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter shares that his father died by suicide when Brandon was 24, and believes that if he had worked harder earlier in life, he might have had enough money to help his dad through whatever crisis he faced.

📑 Contents

- 💔 His Father's Suicide and the Regret of Not Working Harder
- ⚔️ Emergency Mode and the Core Lesson

💔 His Father's Suicide and the Regret of Not Working Harder 0:00

- Brandon was **24 years old** when his father took his own life
  - He does not know the full extent of what his father was going through, even to this day
  - He believes there is a specific dollar amount that, if he had possessed it, could have saved his father
    - "There is an amount of money that if I had it, I'd still have a dad."
- He reflects that if he had gone "super hard" after college — or even during college — he might have earned enough to help his father
  - He acknowledges the number might have been more than a very young man could realistically make, especially before the internet was widely used as a business tool
  - But he argues that working hard earlier would have made it *easier* to provide support during that critical period
- Instead, by his own admission, he was "fucking around" during his 20s
  - Shortly after, his father died by suicide and the global economy collapsed simultaneously

⚔️ Emergency Mode and the Core Lesson 0:46

- After both tragedies hit, Brandon was forced into emergency mode
  - He worked **3–4 jobs** at a time
  - He worked **12–14 hours a day**
  - This grind lasted approximately **2 years**

- His core argument: if he had put in that same work *before* the crisis, he would have been far better positioned to handle it
- He closes with two related maxims that capture the lesson:
  - "The more you sweat during peace, the less you bleed during war."
  - "Dig your well before you need it."
- The implicit takeaway: don't wait for catastrophe to motivate hard work — build financial and personal capacity during stable times so you have real options when everything falls apart.